Samantha Day Briggs

Odum School of Ecology
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Appointments

2025 – **Postdoctoral Researcher**, Odum School of Ecology, University of Georgia.
Mentor: Megan Vahsen.

Education

2019 – 2025 **Ph.D. Genetics**. University of Georgia.
Advisor: Jill T. Anderson.
Dissertation title: *Floral evolution in a changing world: The effects of climate change on floral traits and plant-pollinator interactions*

2014 – 2017 **B.S. Genetics**. University of Georgia.

2014 – 2017 **B.S. Psychology**, *emphasis in neuroscience.* University of Georgia.

Publications

Peer-reviewed Publications

1. **Day Briggs, S.** and Anderson, J.T."Spatial mismatches of plant-pollinator interactions under future climate conditions", *Journal of Biogeography*, 2026; 53(4); e70204. https://doi.org/10.1111/jbi.70204
2. **Day Briggs, S.** and Anderson, J.T. "The Effect of Global Change on The Expression and Evolution of Floral Traits", *Annals of Botany*, 2025; mcae057. https://doi.org/10.1093/aob/mcae057
3. Hamann, E., D.A. Denney, **S. Day**, E. Lombardi, M.I. Jameel, R. MacTavish, and J.T. Anderson. Plant eco-evolutionary responses to climate change: Emerging directions. *Plant Science, 2020;*, 110737. https://doi.org/10.1016/j.plantsci.2020.110737

Manuscripts in review

1. Vahsen, M.L., Ashander, J., **Day Briggs, S.**, Blum, M., Megonigal, J.P., and McLachlan, J.S. "Plastic and evolutionary responses of plants to sea level rise alter marsh ecosystem processes: Lessons from an eco-evolutionary model", *in Review, Proceedings of the Royal Society B*

Preprints and In Prep

**indicates undergraduate mentee*

1. **Day Briggs, S.**, Howard, M.C.*, and Anderson, J.T.. "Pollinator preference for large flowers contrasts with clinal variation in flower size ", BioRxiv
2. **Day Briggs, S.**, Blum, M., and Vahsen, M.L.. "Evolutionary shifts in reproductive allocation in a coastal sedge", draft manuscript in review with co-authors

Awards & Fellowships

2024	Linton and June Bishop Fellowship for Excellence in Research, University of Georgia $1,500
2023	Mary Case Award for Excellence in Teaching and Mentoring, University of Georgia $1,000
2023	University of Georgia's Outstanding Teaching Assistant Award
2022	American Iris Society Foundation Research Grant, $19,127
2022	Future Faculty Fellow, University of Georgia, $600
2021	Robin Hightower Research Award, $1,000
2020	Seed Grants in the Sciences, University of Georgia, *co-authored with Jill T. Anderson* $24,760
2022	Innovative and Interdisciplinary Research Award, University of Georgia $2,000

Presentations

2025	Ecology, Diversity, Genetics, and Evolution Seminar Series. University of Georgia. Athens, GA.
2025	Genetics Departmental Exit Seminar. University of Georgia. Athens, GA.
2024	University of North Georgia. Gainesville, GA.
2023	Ecology, Diversity, Genetics, and Evolution Seminar Series. University of Georgia. Athens, GA.
2022	Graduate Student Seminar Series, Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory. Crested Butte, CO.

Mentored Presentations

2024	Daliz Casablanca Sanchez, SUNFIG/REU poster presentation. Athens, GA.

Teaching & Mentoring Experience

Courses of Record

2020-2023	Instructor, Biology 1107L, *Introductory Molecular Biology Lab*	University of Georgia

Teaching Assistant

2025	GENE4230, *Evolutionary Biology*	University of Georgia
2025	BIOL49X0R, *Faculty-Mentored Undergraduate Research*, Scientific Writing Instructor	University of Georgia
2023 – 2025	GENE 3000, *Evolution*	University of Georgia
2021	BIOL2107H *Honors Introductory Biology: Molecular Biology*	University of Georgia

Programming Instruction

2023 – 2024	Active learning and teaching success workshops	University of Georgia

Mentoring Programs

2024	University of Georgia Young Dawgs Program, Athens, GA
2023	Summer Undergraduate Fellowship in Genetics REU, UGA
	Crop, Genetics, & Genomics REU, UGA
2022	University of Georgia Young Dawgs Program, Athens, GA
2016	University of Georgia Young Scholars Program, Griffin, GA

Undergraduate Students

**indicates REU student*

2025 –	Erin Brown	University of Georgia
2025 –	Victoria Cone	University of Georgia
2025 –	Sophie Smith	University of Georgia
2025 –	Melissa Garcia	University of Georgia
2025 –	Tessa Cote	University of Georgia
2024 – 2025	Mallory Howard	University of Georgia
2024	*Daliz Casablanca Sanchez	University of Georgia
2023 –2024	Shawn Rahim	University of Georgia
2023 –2024	Daniel Cardis	University of Georgia
2023 – 2024	Alexa Leahy	University of Georgia
2023 –2024	Amanda Wijesinghe	University of Georgia
2022 –2024	Leena Patel	University of Georgia
2022– 2023	Caroline McConnell	University of Georgia
2022 – 2023	Jane Aloi	University of Georgia
2022 – 2023	Ron Saler	University of Georgia
2022–2023	Nikhil Manocha	University of Georgia
2022	Nora Oviatt	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2022	Andrew Kluttz	University of Georgia
2022	Manav Kumar	University of Georgia
2021–2022	Pratik Patel	University of Georgia
2021–2022	Ian Volmer	University of Georgia
2021 –2022	Kira Hills	University of Georgia
2021–2022	Zoe Bunch	University of Georgia
2021	Annette Marks	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Rachael Eggleston	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Bronwyn Taylor	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Emma Fetterly	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Ally Wong	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Anthony Lee	University of Georgia
2020	Paige Rumery	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2020	Jade Grimm	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2019	Eric Mayo	University of Georgia
2018	Michala Le	University of Georgia

High School Mentorship

2024	Irina Robinson (Young Dawgs Mentee)
2022	Saisri Tangirala (Young Dawgs Mentee)
2016	Akiel Etienne (Young Dawgs Mentee)
2016	Zabeena Dharani (Young Dawgs Mentee)

Leadership, Service, and Outreach Activities

2024	Guest Research Speaker, Public tour of Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2024	Organizer, Spring Teaching Symposium	University of Georgia
2023 – 2024	Future Faculty Fellow	University of Georgia
2023	Organizer, TA Orientation	University of Georgia
2023	Mentor, Integrated Plant Sciences	University of Georgia
2023	Panelist, TA Orientation	University of Georgia
2022	Co-author, Genetics and Plant Biology Field Safety Guide	University of Georgia
2018	Science Tutor	
2013	Orientation Leader	Middle Georgia State University

Workshops Attended

2025	Coastal Resilience Symposium	University of Georgia
2024	Identity-Based Field Safety Workshop	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2023	Genomics Data Carpentry Workshop	University of Georgia
2022	Southeastern Population Ecology and Evolutionary Genetics Meeting	Eatonton, GA
2022	Field Station Management Workshop	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2022	Field Station Finances Workshop	Rocky Mountain Biological Laboratory
2021	Safer Science Field Safety Workshop	Cornell University

Journal Reviewer

Annals of Botany (3), Journal of Ecology (2), Ecology (1), Proceedings of the Royal Society B (1)